

Fish

Fish live, breathe, and swim in fresh or saltwater. They have inner skeletons, including skull, ribs, and backbone. Fish extract oxygen from the water using gills and swim using their tail and fins. A fish's skin is covered in tough scales.

Jawless fish

Hagfish and lampreys are long, slimy, eel-like fish with no biting jaws. Hagfish are not true fish, or even true vertebrates, since they lack a backbone. They do have a skull, though, and are the closest living relatives of true fish.



Lampreys attach their round sucker mouths to aquatic animals and bite through the flesh to suck the blood.



Hagfish have four hearts and a slitlike mouth surrounded by tentacles. If threatened, they release a sticky slime.

Cartilaginous fishes

Sharks, rays, and deep-water chimaeras have an internal skeleton made of flexible cartilage rather than bone. Special sense organs allow cartilaginous fish to track other animals by detecting their electrical fields.



Hammerhead sharks are named after their unusually shaped heads. Eyes and nostrils are located on each end.



The manta ray is the largest of the rays. It can measure 25 ft (7.5 m) across and lives in tropical seas.



The gray reef shark swims in waters around coral reefs. It feeds on bony fish and crustaceans.



The fins on a common skate fan out from its head, giving it its distinctive shape.

Bony fish

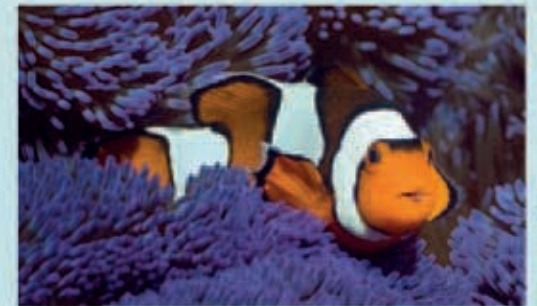
Most species of fish are members of the bony fish group. They have a skeleton of bone and most are covered in overlapping scales. Bony fish come in all shapes and sizes and survive in almost every water habitat. There are more than 25,000 species alive today.



Catfish have prominent touch organs, or barbels, that resemble a cat's whiskers. They use them to search for food.



Like all bottom-dwelling flatfish, the yellowtail flounder has eyes that are both located on one side of the head.



Clownfish live within the stinging tentacles of sea anemones, which are poisonous to other fish.



The Atlantic sailfin shark uses its long bill to stun and kill its prey.